

STRIDE · USER GUIDE

Field Operations Guide

OPERATOR

Everything you need to manage classes, track attendance, keep students safe, and stay connected with your team — from the palm of your hand.

Stride Association Management Platform · Document version 1.0

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1. Your Role & What You Can Do

As an Operator, you are the person on the ground — a teacher, coach, or instructor who runs classes and interacts directly with students and families. Stride gives you everything you need to manage your day without paperwork, while keeping the Admin informed automatically.

1.1 Standard permissions

By default, every Operator can:

- View their assigned schedule and class rosters
- Scan student QR codes for attendance check-in and check-out
- Award Gold Stars to students
- Report their own absence
- Send messages to enrolled families
- Use the SOS emergency button

1.2 Extended permissions (granted by Admin)

If your Admin has given you additional trust, you may also be able to:

- Propose new courses or workshops for Admin approval
- Accept and manage private lesson bookings
- Edit or cancel specific class sessions

If you're not sure which permissions you have, check with your Admin — or simply try the action and the app will tell you clearly if it isn't available to you.

TIP

If you are also a parent/guardian of a student at this association, you can switch between your Operator view and your Member/Parent view using the role switcher in your profile. Your roles are completely separate — what you see as Operator stays private from what families see as Members.

2. Dashboard — Your Daily Command View

The Dashboard is the first screen you see when you open the app. It's designed to give you everything relevant to today, at a glance, without needing to navigate anywhere.

2.1 What you see on the dashboard

Element	What it shows
Today's summary	Number of students present, active classes today, and Smart Pick-Up requests pending.
QR Scanner button	Opens the camera scanner for student check-in/out — the most-used action in your day.
Today's schedule	Your classes for today with time, studio, and current attendance numbers.
Roll call panel	The live attendance list for the class currently in session — tap any student to mark them present, absent, or late.
Rescue requests	If another Operator has reported an absence, you may see a substitute request here — see Section 8.

2.2 SOS button

The SOS button is always visible on the dashboard — see Section 7 for full details. Never move it, cover it, or disable it.

3. QR Attendance Scanner & Smart Check-in

Stride's QR scanner is the fastest way to mark attendance — a single scan takes less than a second and instantly records the check-in with a visual and sound confirmation.

3.1 Scanning a student in

- 1 Tap Scan QR Code on the dashboard or the scanner button.
- 2 Point the camera at the student's QR pass (shown in their Stride app or printed badge).
- 3 The result appears instantly — green for allowed, red for denied, yellow for a warning that needs your attention.

3.2 What the scan result tells you

Result	What it means	What to do
✔ Green — Allowed	Student is active, subscription paid, medical certificate valid.	Let them in, attendance logged automatically.
⚠ Yellow — Warning	Student is allowed today but has an expiring document (certificate, payment due soon).	Let them in, flag the family to sort it soon.
❌ Red — Denied	Subscription lapsed, certificate expired, or student is on the security alert list.	Do not allow entry. Direct the family to the Admin.
? Error	QR could not be verified (network issue, invalid pass).	Ask the member to refresh their QR pass in the app and try again. Do not allow entry on an unverified scan.

IMPORTANT

If a scan shows an error, do not assume it is a technical glitch and let the person through manually without verification. Ask them to refresh their QR pass (open the app, tap the QR icon — it refreshes automatically) and scan again.

3.3 Guardian / Smart Pick-Up scanning

At the end of a class, when a guardian arrives to collect a child, scan their QR pass (shown in their own Stride app). The system verifies whether that person is authorised to collect that specific child. If the scan shows red or error for a pickup request, do not release the child — contact the Admin or the child's registered emergency contact immediately.

3.4 Offline scanning

If your venue has no signal, the scanner queues all check-ins locally and syncs them automatically as soon as a connection is available. You will see a small indicator when working offline — continue scanning normally.

4. Student Management

4.1 Viewing your students

Students shows all students enrolled in your classes. Tap any student to see their profile: allergies, emergency contact, attendance history, and Gold Stars earned.

4.2 Gold Stars — the achievement system

You can award a Gold Star to any student directly from their profile or from the roll call during a session. When you assign a star, the student's parent receives an instant in-app notification with your note — creating a direct, positive connection between your classes and the family at home.

- 1 Open the student's profile or tap their name in the roll call.
- 2 Tap **Award Gold Star**.
- 3 Add a short note (optional but recommended — "Brilliant footwork today" means much more than just a star).
- 4 Confirm — the parent is notified immediately.

4.3 Student detail & progress diary

The **Progress Diary** for each student shows their full history of Gold Stars, attendance, and any notes you or other Operators have added. Use it to track development over time, especially for students working toward specific goals.

4.4 ID Badges

PDF Badges lets you generate and print QR badges for students who prefer a physical card over using the app — useful for younger children or venues where phones are not permitted during class.

5. Schedule & Availability

5.1 Your calendar

[Calendar](#) shows your full schedule — all classes assigned to you, with times, venues, and enrolled student counts. Tap any class to see the full roster and session details.

5.2 Setting your availability

[My Availability](#) and [Availability Preferences](#) let you tell the system when you are generally available to work. This information is used by the Admin's AI Roster Orchestrator when looking for substitute coverage — the more accurate your availability, the more likely you'll be contacted for substitutions that actually fit your schedule.

5.3 Skills setup

[Skills Setup](#) is where you register your qualifications and disciplines (e.g. Ballet, Jazz, First Aid certification). Keep this up to date — the substitute matching algorithm uses your skills to decide whether to contact you for a specific class, so an outdated profile means you might be skipped for opportunities that actually suit you.

6. Private Lessons

If your Admin has enabled private lesson management for you, [Private Lessons](#) shows all one-on-one lesson requests from members, and lets you accept, decline, or reschedule them.

- New requests appear with the student's name, preferred date/time, and any notes from the family
 - Accepting a request adds it to your calendar automatically
 - The family receives a confirmation notification when you accept
 - Your earnings from private lessons are tracked separately in [Invoicing](#)
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7. Safety — SOS & Emergency Tools

Stride gives Operators two distinct emergency tools, designed for different situations.

7.1 SOS button — double-tap

Double-tap the SOS button quickly (within 3 seconds) to send an immediate emergency alert to your Admin with your GPS location. Use this for any genuine emergency: a student injury, a medical incident, a security concern, or any situation requiring the Admin's immediate intervention.

When triggered, your Admin receives a high-priority push notification with your location. The app then shows you escalation options (call emergency services, notify parents, contact additional staff) depending on the type of emergency you select.

7.2 Silent alarm — press and hold

Press and hold the SOS button for 3 or more seconds to trigger a silent alarm. This sends the same emergency alert to the Admin but with **no visible confirmation, no sound, and no on-screen change** on your device. Use this in situations where triggering a visible alarm could make things worse — for example if you feel unsafe and don't want to draw attention to the fact that you're calling for help.

SAFETY RULE

Never ignore an SOS alert from another Operator or Member. If you receive one while on-site, respond immediately and contact the Admin.

7.3 Reporting a student absence or late pickup

If a student has not been picked up at the end of a class and you cannot reach the registered contacts, use [Security Alerts](#) to flag the situation. The Admin is notified immediately and the escalation timer starts — see your Admin for your association's specific protocol for this situation.

7.4 Emergency Pulse

[Emergency Pulse](#) is a broadcast tool for critical association-wide alerts — fire evacuation, lockdown, or similar. This sends an immediate notification to every member and Operator in your organization simultaneously. Use only in genuine emergencies and only if your Admin has authorized you to do so.

8. Substitute Cascade — Reporting an Absence

If you cannot make a scheduled class, report it as early as possible through the app — the earlier you report, the more time the system has to find a qualified replacement before your students arrive to an unstaffed class.

8.1 Reporting your absence

- 1 From the Dashboard or your Calendar, find the class you cannot attend.
- 2 Tap **Report Absence**.
- 3 Select the reason (optional but helpful for the Admin's records).
- 4 Confirm — the system immediately notifies your Admin and starts the substitute search automatically.

8.2 What happens after you report

Once you report an absence, the system takes over — you don't need to find your own replacement. Behind the scenes:

- The AI Roster Orchestrator ranks qualified, available Operators and contacts the best match first
- Each candidate has 5 minutes to accept or decline
- If no one accepts within 15 minutes, your Admin is escalated to make a final decision (cancel, reschedule, or find someone manually)
- Once a substitute accepts, all enrolled families are automatically notified of who will be taking the class

8.3 Receiving a substitute request

If you receive a push notification asking if you can cover another Operator's class, you'll see the full details: course name, date, time, location, and the students involved. You have 5 minutes to accept or decline from the notification or from the **Rescue Request** panel on your Dashboard. Accepting adds the class to your calendar immediately — the requesting Operator and the Admin are both notified that coverage is confirmed.

TIP

Your reliability score (used by the system to prioritize who gets contacted first for future substitutions) improves every time you accept a request and worsens if you regularly decline or don't respond. Keeping your availability up to date helps the system contact you only when you're genuinely free.

9. Communications & Notifications

9.1 Messaging families

[Messages](#) and [Communications](#) let you send messages to the families of students in your classes — reminders, updates, or general announcements. Messages are sent as in-app notifications; your Admin may also have enabled email or WhatsApp as additional channels.

9.2 Notification settings

[Notification Settings](#) lets you control which categories of alerts you receive and how — lesson reminders, emergency alerts, and substitute requests can each be adjusted independently. The emergency alert channel cannot be fully disabled for safety reasons.

10. Your Profile, Skills & Earnings

10.1 Profile & account

[Profile](#) and [Profile Edit](#) let you update your personal details, profile photo, and contact information. Keep these current so the Admin and families can reach you reliably.

10.2 Certificates

[Certificates](#) shows the professional certifications registered against your profile (first aid, teaching qualifications, discipline certifications). Upload or update them here — expired certificates may affect which classes you're eligible to teach, and the system will not assign you as a substitute for disciplines that require a certification you don't hold.

10.3 Invoicing & earnings

[Invoicing](#) shows a record of classes taught, private lessons completed, and any reimbursements owed to you. Your Admin uses this data for payroll processing — review it regularly and flag any discrepancies early.

10.4 Contract

[Contract](#) shows any employment or engagement agreement your Admin has shared with you through the app. You can review and sign digitally here — the signed version is stored automatically for both parties.

11. Troubleshooting & FAQ

A student's QR scan keeps showing an error — what do I do?

Ask the student (or their parent) to open the Stride app and tap their QR icon to refresh their pass — passes are valid for 24 hours and auto-refresh while the app is open, but a fresh load resolves most scan errors. If the error persists after refreshing, contact your Admin — do not allow entry on a repeatedly failing scan.

I accidentally marked someone present when they weren't there.

Contact your Admin as soon as you notice — they can correct attendance records from the Admin panel. You cannot edit past attendance records from the Operator app directly.

I reported an absence but haven't heard anything — was it received?

Once you confirm the absence report, you'll see a confirmation on screen and the cascade starts automatically. You don't need to hear anything back — the system handles the substitution process and notifies you only if it needs something from you specifically. If you're concerned, check with your Admin directly.

I received a substitute request but can't open it in time.

Each request has a 5-minute window. If it expires before you respond, the system moves on to the next candidate automatically — you don't need to decline explicitly. If you missed it and want to help anyway, contact your Admin directly.

Where do I go for help not covered here?

[Support](#) in your Operator menu connects you directly with Stride support.

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